

Fuji S602 Zoom Digital Camera

Resolve to click

The S602 looks good with a dual-tone colour finish and rounded contours. The ergonomics of the camera is spot on with perfect weight balance. It is powered by four AA batteries that are placed such that they balance out the weight of the lens.

The controls have been placed thoughtfully—the mode selection dial surrounds the shutter release button and the zoom controls are slightly angled to make it comfortable to be operated by the thumb. The exposure mode selector has a rubberised feel and provides good grip, and the command wheel is placed within thumb reach and offers a good tactile feel.

It has a 3.1 megapixel CCD count and is provided with a zoom lens with 6x zoom. The camera features the third generation Super CCD technology, which helps in interpolating the image to 6 million pixels. You can also record a VGA video at 30 fps with the resolution set to 640x480. Its 1.8-inch TFT LCD monitor is easy to use indoors, but as with all LCD monitors, it's difficult to use in bright sunlight, however you can use the Electronic View Finder, which has a tiny 0.44-inch LCD, instead.

This camera includes a 16 MB Smart Flash card and is compatible with both Compact Flash type I/II slot and IBM's micro-drive. It can be hooked on to a computer using the USB port, or the

Video Out jack. It also has a DC-In jack and a tripod stand mount. There are several automatic modes to make it easy for the aim-and-shoot users. A very interesting feature is the 'last five' continuous shooting mode, where the camera takes up to 25 frames but records only the last five frames—particularly useful when shooting at a sports event where you can predict the moment and start shooting just before the finish so you don't miss the action.

In our test the camera captured fairly good details, producing good tonal balance, except that the red colour had a slight orange tinge when seen using the Histogram feature of PhotoShop. Also, the edges of the picture showed a blue halo. In our resolution test, the camera reproduced a high-quality image at a native resolution of 2832x2128.

All in all, this high-end digital camera has good features. Its 6x optical zoom and support for attaching lenses such as telephoto and wide fish eye lens, make it a good choice for professionals. The only real hindrance is the price—at Rs 66,000 it is too expensive for a casual shutter-bug.

SPECIFICATIONS

3.1 megapixel zoom lens, 6x optical zoom, 1.8-inch LCD monitor, 16 MB Smart Flash card, four AA batteries

Fuji S602		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

Price: Rs 66,000

Contact: Jindal Photo films

Phone: 022-28504949

Fax: 022-28504044

E-mail: k_mohan/jpl@jindals.com

Web site: www.fuji.com

HP 5550 Deskjet Printer

Hey good lookin'

This silver coloured printer sports a futuristic design with matt grey paper flaps and a translucent black hood that covers the cartridge bay. This hood opens just like the hatch of a car and then slides along the body surface. However, the printer has a rather large foot print.

HP has revised the printer design to include support for new types of standard cartridges and photo-cartridge. The cartridge installation is simple and requires no force for getting them in place. The cartridges use a smaller drop size and the printer comes with PhotoRet IV which means it provides six basic colours instead of four. Also, PhotoRet IV has 1.2 million colours as opposed to the 3,500 in PhotoRet III mode.

Depending on the cartridge, the printer works in different modes.

With standard cartridges the printer shifts to PhotoRet III (for text printing); with Photo Cartridge the printer works in PhotoRet IV (for printing images). The printer automatically adjusts the print resolution depending on the paper quality. To print at the maximum rated resolution (4800x1200) the paper type has to be selected manually.

The printer has support for A4 sheets and up to 100 sheets can be loaded in one go. The paper output flap can handle 50 sheets, however, the locking mechanism is not

strong enough to hold this weight. The printer has an 8 MB buffer and has an IEEE 1284-B parallel port and a USB port for connecting to a PC.

In our tests, it printed text in black and white mode at a relatively good speed of 9 PPM. In the fast draft mode, it was exceptionally fast, scoring 13 PPM compared to the normal mode of operation. In the combination document test, it printed the test file under a minute in the greyscale mode, which is pretty fast. It surprised us by taking the same amount of time to print this file in colour mode! It took approximately 300 seconds (5 minutes) to print the test image, which is fast enough for a printer in the mid-range category. It took around 180 seconds (3 minutes) to print the image in greyscale.

The print quality was crisp and clear, with no smudging or jarring. The image quality test showed slight saturation in the colour reproduction. The HP 5550 delivers good printing speed, especially for text and combination documents. Though the image printing speed is a bit slow, it makes up for this with good image quality—a good choice if you want a printer for daily office printing work and to occasionally print photographs.

SPECIFICATIONS

4800x1200 dpi printing, one USB, one parallel port, 8 MB buffer, 100 sheet input tray

HP 5550 Deskjet		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

Price: Rs 9,990

Contact: Hewlett-Packard India Ltd

Phone: 011-2682 6000

Fax: 011-2682 6053

E-mail: seema_dawar@hp.com

Web site: www.hpindia.com